No Garland Neuroscience 2026

Schedule

22nd - 25th October 2026 | Mohali, Punjab

Day 1: Thursday, 22nd October 2026

Venue: IISER Mohali

10:00 - 14:00 **Registration**
IISER Mohali

13:00 - 14:00 **Welcome Lunch**
IISER Mohali

Session 1: Neuronal Metabolism and Signaling

14:00 - 14:30 **Rajesh Ramachandran**
Chromatin–immune–matrix crosstalk determines regenerative competence across vertebrates.

14:30 - 14:50 **Kamal Kishore**
Characterizing the function of the PUF family of RNA-binding proteins in *Caenorhabditis elegans*.

14:50 - 15:20 **Abhishek Bhattacharya**
Leucine is essential in maintaining neuronal health during starvation in *C. elegans*.

15:20 - 15:40 **Nitisha Kuila**
Role of SUMOylation in the group I metabotropic glutamate receptor trafficking.

15:40 - 16:00 **Palamou Das**
Optical sensor for real-time measurement of ER–mitochondria interaction in cells.

16:00 - 16:30 **Saikat Ghosh**
Lysosome-coupled mRNA transport maintains axonal mitochondrial homeostasis and prevents axonal degeneration.

16:30 - 17:00 **Mohit Kumar**
Ketogenic diet enhances brain resilience in estrogen deficiency by improving mitochondrial functions and modulating gut microbiota.

17:00 - 17:20 *Tea Break*

Session 2: Sensory Processing, Behavior & Coding

17:20 - 17:40 **Sharanya H**
Elucidating the role of FLP-12 in the regulation of amplitude of body bends of *Caenorhabditis elegans*.

17:40 - 18:00 **Vinod Kumar**
How meditation changes brain and body: investigating the effects of meditation on functional connectivity and physiology.

18:00 - 18:20 **Hanuma Sai Billakurthi**
Experience adaptively retunes human learning in stochastic reward environments.

18:20 - 18:40 **Madhurima Roy**
Representations of odor mixtures in the antennal lobe of *Aedes aegypti*.

19:00 *Dinner and Networking*

Day 2: Friday, 23rd October 2026

Venue: BRIC-NABI

Session 3: Neural Plasticity, Circuits and Behaviour

09:30 - 10:00 **Anant Jain**
Plasticity mechanisms underlying spatial memories.

10:00 - 10:20 **Atal Vats**
Assembly of heteromeric stomatin caps functionally regulate electrical synapses in *C. elegans*.

10:20 - 10:40 **Ananya Bandyopadhyay**
Cell biological principles governing heteromeric stomatin cap assembly at electrical synapses in *C. elegans*.

10:40 - 11:00 **Rounak Saha**
A brain–liver circuit modulating liver regeneration in liver diseases.

11:00 - 11:30 *Tea Break*

11:30 - 11:50 **Arunima Sen**
Molecularly distinct innexin gap junctions and undocked hemichannels regulate glia morphology and behaviour in *Caenorhabditis elegans*.

11:50 - 12:10 **Akankshya Sahu**
Distinct molecular mechanisms regulate feeding state-dependent CO_2 chemotaxis plasticity during different life stages in *Caenorhabditis elegans*.

12:10 - 12:40 **Sufyan Ashhad**
From latent rhythms to breaths: neural population dynamics of flexible motor output.

12:40 - 13:40 *Lunch Break*

Session 4: Molecular & Cellular Foundations of Neuroscience

13:40 - 14:10 **Kavita Babu**
Eavesdropping on worm conversations: investigating the transfer of memory from one worm to another.

14:10 - 14:30 **Vartika Srivastava**
No complement, no chill – role of complement proteins in recovery from stress.

14:30 - 14:50 **Subhajit Pal**
The role of the antagonist in the group I mGluR trafficking and mGluR-mediated AMPA receptor endocytosis.

14:50 - 15:20 **Baskar Bakthavachalu**
Title to be announced.

15:20 - 15:35 **Flash Talks from Selected Posters**
Will be announced.

15:35 - 18:00 *Poster Session 2 and Evening Tea*

18:00 - 19:00 **Panel Discussion**
Panel and topic to be decided.

19:00 *Dinner and Networking*

Day 3: Saturday, 24th October 2026

Venue: BRIC-NABI

Session 5: Evolution, Cognition & Networks

09:00 - 09:30 **Bittu Kaveri Rajaraman**
The evolution of neural systems underlying communication and quantitative cognition.

09:30 - 09:50 **Aakash Sharma and Saksham Deol**
Adaptability and efficiency in the brain – evolutionary insights from neuroplasticity and lateralization with implications in autism.

09:50 - 10:20 **Sneha Shashidhara**
Understanding the frontoparietal multiple-demand network.

10:20 - 10:40 **Anzal Kannamkualth Shahul Hameed**
From neural circuits to 3D kinematics: multimodal interrogation of adaptive motor control in the cerebellar nuclei.

10:40 - 11:00 **Indraja Rajendra Jakhalekar**
Representation of space in the rat dorsal CA1 as a function of arena size.

11:00 - 11:15 *Tea Break*

11:15 - 11:45 **Surya Narayan Biswal**
The long shadow of depression: from brain development to aging.

Session 6: Behavioral & Affective Neuroscience

11:45 - 12:15 **Krishna Melnattur**
Mutations in *Drosophila* antimicrobial peptides differently affect sleep and plasticity.

12:15 - 12:35 **Ozoswita Roy Deb**
Recognition memory for natural scenes is supported by temporal context reinstatement in the medial temporal lobe across multiple timescales.

12:35 - 13:05 **Chandrashekhar Borkar**
Central amygdala projections diverge to regulate distinct defensive responses in mice.

13:05 - 14:00 *Lunch Break*

Session 7: Neurodegeneration & Neurological Disorders

14:00 - 14:30 **Mayanglambam Dhruba Singh**
Therapeutic potential of targeting Pten in poly(Q) disease models.

14:30 - 14:50 **Sailesh S**
Interfering peptides targeting the slow afterhyperpolarization complex restore intrinsic inhibition and restrict seizures in acquired epilepsy.

14:50 - 15:10 **Shweta Tandon**
Ataxin-2 regulates Zfh1 expression in the adult muscle progenitors to mediate neuromuscular development in *Drosophila melanogaster*.

15:10 - 15:30 **Rituparna Sahu**
Selective activator of calcium-activated potassium channels, NS-309, acts as a novel antiepileptic drug by restricting neuronal hyperexcitability in acquired epilepsy.

15:30 - 15:50 **Shriya Palchaudhuri**
From cohorts to mechanisms: advancing the biology of neuropsychiatric disorders.

15:50 - 16:10	**Vanshika Ahuja** Altered stress granules and paraspeckle dynamics by ALS-associated FUS mutations in neuronal and astrocytic models.
16:10 - 16:40	**Poonam Thakur** Metabolic changes in Parkinson's disease – brain and beyond.
16:40	*Closing Tea Break and Conference Adjournment*

Day 4: Sunday, 25th October 2026

Excursion to Kasauli

Further information on timings, travel arrangements, and what to carry will be conveyed to registered participants later.